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Modular strap for an electronic device

Abstract

A head-mountable display (HMD) system includes a display portion, a modular securement assembly connectable to the display portion, and a dongle configured to connect the removable strap to at least one of a power supply, a computing device, or an external display. In some examples, the modular securement assembly includes: a removable strap with an electronics pod with a thermal shell and a thermal conduit; and a retention band connectable to the removable strap.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION(S) (1) This application claims priority to U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 63/479,145, filed 9 Jan. 2023 and entitled “Modular Strap for an Electronic Device,” the disclosure of which is hereby incorporated by reference in its entirety.

FIELD

(1) The described embodiments relate generally to wearable electronic devices. More particularly, the present embodiments relate to modular wearable electronic devices and associated components.

BACKGROUND

(2) Recent advances in portable computing have enabled head-mountable display (HMD) systems that provide augmented and virtual reality (AR/VR) experiences to users. These HMD systems have many components, such as a display, viewing frame, lens, batteries, and other components. Certain components of the HMD system can also help create a unique user experience. HMD display systems typically include a display, where a user can view and interact with visualizations presented on the display screen of the HMD.

(3) In addition, conventional HMD systems can also be difficult to program, develop, and test new software. Indeed, conventional HMD systems suffer from a lack of efficient connectivity that can facilitate adequate testing parameters. Furthermore, thermal ergonomics are a challenge for HMD systems. In particular, thermal ergonomics are an increasing challenge as HMD system components are designed with reduced form factors that typically draw thermal elements closer to the user, which can add to user discomfort. Additionally, increases in thermal energy dissipation often result in component degradation. Therefore, there is a need for improvement to the connectivity to HMD systems while reducing an amount of heat transferred to users.

SUMMARY

(4) An aspect of the present disclosure relates to a head-mountable display (HMD) system. The HMD system can include a display portion with a display, a modular securement assembly connectable to the display portion, and a dongle connectable to the removable strap and to at least one of a power supply, a computing device, or an external display. In some examples, the modular securement assembly includes: a removable strap comprising an electronics pod with a thermal shell and a thermal conduit; and a retention band connectable to the removable strap.

(5) The HMD system can further include a processor that, in response to a threshold thermal output of the electronics pod, throttles a power bandwidth or a data bandwidth through the removable strap. In some examples, the dongle comprises a split dongle configured to connect the removable strap to the power supply and at least one of the computing device or the external display. In another example, the dongle comprises a split dongle configured to connect the removable strap to an additional removable strap.

(6) In certain examples, the thermal shell comprises a clad with at least a copper layer, a first stainless steel layer, and a second stainless steel layer. In particular examples, the copper layer is positioned between the first stainless steel layer and the second stainless steel layer. The thermal conduit can comprise a first thermal connector configured to thermally couple one or more components of the electronics pod and the copper layer. In particular examples, the thermal conduit comprises a second thermal connector configured to thermally couple the copper layer and a thermal spreader positioned beyond the electronics pod.

(7) Another aspect of the present disclosure relates to a removable strap for an HMD system. The removable strap can include a display connector, a dongle connector, an electronics pod, and a thermal spreader. In some examples, the electronics pod is positioned between the display connector and the dongle connector, the electronics pod comprising a heat source. In certain examples, the thermal spreader is positioned at least between the electronics pod and the dongle connector, the thermal spreader configured to dissipate thermal energy from the electronics pod.

(8) In one or more examples, the electronics pod comprises a thermal shell comprising a thermal interface material. In particular examples, the thermal shell is overmolded with a fluorocarbon rubber. In certain examples, the electronics pod comprises an outer surface defining an etched portion exposing the thermal shell. In at least one example, the thermal spreader is in contact with the thermal shell through the etched portion. In one example, the thermal shell is at least partially

exposed inside the electronics pod. In one example, the thermal interface material comprises at least one of a copper layer or a graphite layer. In one example, the heat source comprises at least one of a battery of a system-on-chip.

(9) Yet another aspect of the present disclosure relates to an HMD system. The HMD system can include a display portion, a modular securement assembly connectable to the display portion, a first dongle, and a second dongle. In these or other examples, the modular securement assembly comprises: a first removable strap comprising a first thermal shell and a first thermal spreader, a second removable strap comprising a second thermal shell and a second thermal spreader, and a retention band. In one or more examples, the first dongle is configured to connect the first removable strap to a power supply, and the second dongle is configured to connect the second removable strap to at least one of a computing device or an external display.

(10) In one example, the first dongle comprises a first bandwidth, and the second dongle comprises a second bandwidth greater than the first bandwidth. In one example, at least data is transmissive through the second dongle. In one example, at least one of the first dongle or the second dongle comprises a cable management mechanism.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The disclosure will be readily understood by the following detailed description in conjunction with the accompanying drawings, wherein like reference numerals designate like structural elements, and in which:

(2) FIG. 1 shows a top view of an example of an electronic device donned by a user;

(3) FIG. 2 shows a perspective view of an example of an electronic device;

(4) FIG. 3 shows an exploded perspective view of an example of an electronic device;

(5) FIG. 4 shows a side profile view of an example removable strap of an HMD system;

(6) FIG. 5 shows a top cross-sectional profile view of an example electronics pod;

(7) FIG. 6 shows a top view of another example of an electronic device donned by a user; and

(8) FIGS. 7-8 show example cable management mechanisms of an example HMD system.

(9) FIG. 9 illustrates a side view of a dongle in accordance with one or more examples of the present disclosure.

(10) FIG. 10 illustrate a close-up view of a dongle boot in accordance with one or more examples of the present disclosure.

(11) FIGS. 11-12 illustrate an exploded assembly view and a cross-sectional view, respectively, of a dongle connection in accordance with one or more examples of the present disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(12) Detailed reference will now be made to representative embodiments illustrated in the accompanying drawings. The following descriptions are not intended to limit the embodiments to one preferred embodiment. Rather, it is intended to cover alternatives, modifications, and equivalents as can be included within the spirit and scope of the described embodiments as defined by the appended claims.

(13) As virtual reality (VR) and mixed reality (MR) become more ubiquitous, the demand for user friendly head-mounted displays with quality components increases. Traditionally, these VR/MR systems have been devices that include a wearable display component, often referred to as a head-mounted display (HMD) and a supplemental unit. The supplemental unit can be part of the HMD, or can be a separate component that is permanently or removably connected to the HMD through a cable, wires, or other conductors. The supplemental unit can provide power and/or added processing functionality to the system.

(14) Devices of the present disclosure include one or more additional dongles for improved

connectivity to such supplemental components. For example, an HMD system of the present disclosure includes a first dongle for attaching a power supply to a first removable strap (e.g., a modular band of the HMD system). In addition, the HMD system includes a second dongle for attaching an external computing device or display to a second removable strap (e.g., another modular band of the HMD system). With separate, designated dongles (e.g., one for power and the other for data transmission), the HMD system of the present disclosure can significantly improve throughput. Advantageously, this can facilitate developers or programmers to rapidly upload and download data from the HMD system, while separately powering the device.

(15) In addition, the present disclosure relates to various thermal ergonomic improvements for a removable strap. Removable straps can include a variety of electrical components, including a battery, integrated circuit, and a speaker (to name a few). Such electrical components can generate large amounts of thermal energy, particularly for longer use durations and heavy computing applications. Thus, given the location of a removable strap (and its associated electrical components) being next to a user's head, managing thermal output is important.

(16) To reduce or mitigate hotspots along the removable straps, the present disclosure includes electrical pods positioned along the removable straps. These electrical pods can include a thermal shell and other thermal elements that provide a combination of heat shielding and heat dissipation. In so doing, the removable straps can provide increased comfort to a user. In addition, the removable straps can reduce (or more efficiently spread) a thermal load.

(17) These and other embodiments are discussed below with reference to FIGS. **1-12**. However, those skilled in the art will readily appreciate that the detailed description given herein with respect to these Figures is for explanatory purposes only and should not be construed as limiting. Furthermore, as used herein, a system, a method, an article, a component, a feature, or a sub-feature comprising at least one of a first option, a second option, or a third option should be understood as referring to a system, a method, an article, a component, a feature, or a sub-feature that can include one of each listed option (e.g., only one of the first option, only one of the second option, or only one of the third option), multiple of a single listed option (e.g., two or more of the first option), two options simultaneously (e.g., one of the first option and one of the second option), or combination thereof (e.g., two of the first option and one of the second option).

(18) FIG. **1** shows a top view of a wearable electronic device **100** being worn on the head **101** of a user. The wearable electronic device **100**, as well as other wearable electronic devices disclosed herein, can also be referred to as HMD systems, electronic devices, or simply as devices. The device **100** can include a number of modular components. For example, the device **100** can include a head-mounted display (HMD) **102** including a housing **104** and a display **106** attached to the housing **104** for displaying images to a user.

(19) The HMD can also be referred to as a display portion or display module having the display **106**. The display portion can include the housing **104** and display **106** that at least partially constitutes the HMD. In one or more examples, including the example shown in FIG. **1** and other examples shown in other figures, the HMD **102** can also be referred to as an output component, output module. Such output components, modules, or portions can include one or more outputs other than visual outputs from a display. For example, an output module similar to the HMD **102** can include a speaker that outputs sound instead of or in addition to the display **106** shown in FIG. **1**.

(20) In addition, one example of the device **100** can include a modular securement assembly **108** that secures the HMD **102** to the user's head **101**. The modular securement assembly **108** includes removable straps **110**, **112**. The modular securement assembly **108** further includes a retention band **114**. The modular securement assembly **108** is therefore configured to removably secure the wearable electronic device **100**, including the HMD **102**, to the head **101** of the user when the removable straps **110**, **112** and retention band **114** are connected as shown in FIG. **1**.

(21) In particular examples, the removable straps **110**, **112** removably (i.e., detachably) connect to

both of the HMD **102** and the retention band **114**. For example, each of the removable straps **110**, **112** can be removably connected to the HMD **102** (or the housing or the display portion thereof) and the retention band **114** at opposing ends of each removable strap **110**, **112** as shown in FIG. **1**. In such an example, the modular securement assembly **108** is modular in that each of the removable straps **110**, **112**, and the retention band **114** can be connected and detached, as may be desired. For instance, each of the removable straps **110**, **112** can be removed from the modular securement assembly **108** and swapped out for one or more other modules, straps, or electronic components.

(22) One or more other examples of the device **100** can include alternative configurations of the removable straps **110**, **112** shown in FIG. **1**. For example, the device **100** can be positioned elsewhere along the modular securement assembly **108** (differently than what is shown in FIG. **1**). In addition, one or more examples of wearable electronic devices described herein can include one or more intermediate members, flexible straps, or other optional supplemental components and electronic modules such as external power supplies, memory components, and/or processors.

(23) In the example shown in FIG. **1**, when the device **100** is worn on the head of the user, the removable strap **110** is positioned on the left side of the user's head and the removable strap **112** is positioned on the right side of the user's head. The retention band **114** can span between the removable straps **110**, **112** to wrap around the back of the user's head **101**, as shown.

(24) In some examples, and as shown, the device **100** can be worn on the user's head **101** such that the HMD **102** is worn on the user's face and disposed over one or both of their eyes. The HMD **102** can be removably and/or releasably connected to one or more of the removable straps **110**, **112** as mentioned above. In some examples, the removable straps **110**, **112** can be positioned against the side of a user's head **101** and in contact therewith. In some examples, the removable straps **110**, **112** can be positioned above the user's ear or ears. In some examples, the removable straps **110**, **112** can be positioned adjacent to the user's ear or ears. The removable straps **110**, **112** can be removably connected to the retention band **114**, which can extend around the user's head **101** and removably connect to the other of the removable straps **110**, **112**. In this way, the HMD **102**, removable straps **110**, **112**, and retention band **114** can form a loop that can retain the wearable electronic device **100** on the user's head **101**.

(25) As shown in FIG. **1**, the removable straps **110**, **112** can connect to the HMD **102**, both mechanically and electrically. In particular examples, the removable straps **110**, **112** can receive and/or relay at least one of data or power via such connections. In these or other examples, the removable straps **110**, **112** can connect to the HMD **102** at an HMD connection location that can include an electrical input or electrical connector that is attached to the housing **104** and electrically connected to the display **106**. This location can be identified as a temple area that can be defined as an area near a user's temple adjacent to the user's eye, and can span from in front of the user's eye to approximately 1-1.5 inches past the outer corner of a user's eye, along the side of the user's head **101**.

(26) Similarly, the removable straps **110**, **112** can connect to the retention band **114** at a retention band connection location identified as an area that can span to include the area above the user's ear or within 0.5 inches of the outer edge of the ear on either side. In this manner, the removable straps **110**, **112** are able to provide structural support between the HMD **102** and the user's ear, while securely connecting the retention band **114** and transferring the retention forces of the retention band **114** through the device **100**. It should be understood, however, that this configuration is just one example of how the components of a modular wearable electronic device **100** can be arranged, and that in some, a different number of removable straps and/or retention bands can be included.

(27) While a user wearing an HMD **102** on his or her head **101** is shown as one example of a wearable electronic device, the modular components, features, and advantages of various examples of electronic devices disclosed herein can also apply to other wearable electronic devices having securement mechanisms, including but not limited to wearable smart watches, fitness trackers,

smart glasses, medical monitor devices, and so forth. For example, the housing **104** and display **106** of HMD **102** shown in FIG. **1** can also be configured as a housing and display for a smart watch module secured to the user's arm or wrist via a modular securement mechanism or assembly similar to the securement assembly **108** shown in FIG. **1**. Although referred to as a wearable electronic device **100**, it should be understood that the device **100** can include multiple modular components or devices and can be interchangeably referred to as a wearable electronic device, wearable electronic device system, and/or wearable electronic system. Additionally, although the particular component **102** can be referred to as an HMD, it should be understood that the terms HMD, HMD device, and/or HMD system can be used to refer to the wearable device **100** as a whole.

(28) In particular examples, the device **100** (or HMD system) includes one or more dongles **116**, **118** that are connectable to external components or devices, as will now be discussed. As used herein, the term “dongle” can refer to a piece of electrical hardware such as a connection, adapter, boot, or coupling between an external device/component and one or more components of the device **100** to provide additional functionality, or enable a pass-through to another device that adds functionality. A dongle can include electrical connections for data and/or power transmission through the dongle. In particular examples, a dongle can be uni-directional or bi-directional in terms of data and/or a power transmission.

(29) As shown in FIG. **1**, the dongle **116** connects the removable strap **110** to a power supply **120**. As used herein, the term “power supply” refers to any power source that supplies power to one or more components of the device **100** (e.g., to charge a battery or power a processor such as a microcontroller within the removable strap **110**). For example, a power supply can include fuel cells, battery cells, generators, alternators, solar power converters, motion-based converters (e.g., that convert vibrations or oscillations into power), etc. In particular implementations, a power supply can convert alternating current to direct current (or vice-versa) for charging or recharging components of the device **100**. Some particular examples of a power supply can include a switched mode power supply, an uninterruptible power supply, an alternating current power supply, a direct current power supply, a regulated power supply, a programmable power supply, a computer power supply, and a linear power supply.

(30) Additionally shown in FIG. **1**, the dongle **118** connects the removable strap **112** to an external device or display (DoD) **122**. An external device can include a smartphone, a tablet, a smart television, a desktop computer, a laptop computer, a server/network device, a virtual reality device, an augmented reality device, a smart watch, a sound/speaker device, a camera device, or other computing device. Further, an external display can include a monitor, device screen (e.g., a display screen for a laptop, television, phone, tablet, etc.), projector, or other suitable visual medium.

(31) In at least some examples, the external DoD **122** includes a developer computer (e.g., for receiving and/or transmitting data from one or more components of the device **100**). In particular examples, the external DoD **122** uploads computer-executable instructions to one or more components of the device **100** (e.g., the removable strap **112**) through the dongle **118**. Additionally or alternatively, the external DoD **122** can also provide data to and/or receive data from certain component(s) of the device **100** (e.g., the removable strap **110**) through other dongle configurations, such as through the dongle **116** or a split-dongle configuration (described below in relation to FIG. **6**).

(32) In some examples, the external DoD **122** receives performance data (e.g., thermal data, power data, data throughput data, etc.). In certain implementations, the external DoD **122** provides power to one or more components of the device **100**. For example, the external DoD **122** can power or charge components of the removable strap **112** by providing power through the dongle **118**. In other examples, the external DoD **122** provides no power, in which case the power supply **120** can provide power to components of both the removable strap **110** and the removable strap **112**. For instance, the power supply **120** can relay power to the removable strap **112** via electrical connections between the power supply **120**, the removable strap **110**, the HMD **102**, and the

removable strap **112**. Alternatively, the power supply **120** can relay power to the removable strap **112** via alternative dongle configurations (as described below in relation to FIG. 6).

(33) Additionally or alternatively, the external DoD **122** includes a display that outputs visual information. For example, the external DoD **122** includes a monitor that outputs the same visual content that is shown at the display **106**. Thus, advantageously, the external DoD **122** can provide visual feedback (e.g., to developers or programmers) without needing to wear the device **100**. Similarly, the external DoD **122** can provide visual feedback (e.g., on a developer computer screen) while a user is simultaneously wearing the device **100**.

(34) In one or more examples of the present disclosure, the dongles **116**, **118** can include a variety of bandwidth capacities. In certain examples, the dongle **116** includes a first bandwidth, and the dongle **118** includes a second bandwidth greater than the first bandwidth. For example, the dongle **118** can provide (relative to the dongle **116**) increased throughput of at least one of data or power. In this manner, the dongle **118** can facilitate larger and/or faster data uploads and downloads (for developer work or testing on the device **100**).

(35) In some examples, the dongles **116**, **118** can also include variable bandwidths that can be throttled (e.g., reduced) or increased, as may be desired. For example, the dongles **116**, **118** can include adjusted bandwidths based on one or more performance metrics (e.g., throughput speeds, visual content quality/resolution, thermal output, etc.). Indeed, as will be discussed more below in relation to FIGS. 4-5, an electronics pod on one or both of the removable straps **110**, **112** can generate a thermal output that is spread out or dissipated into the ambient environment (e.g., to reduce heat transfer to a user). To help lessen the thermal output of the electronics pod (and/or an amount of thermal output to dissipate), one or more components of the device **100** can vary (e.g., decrease) the bandwidth through the dongles **116**, **118**. As used herein, the term “bandwidth” refers to a rate of power transfer (i.e., power bandwidth) or a rate of data transfer (i.e., data bandwidth) through electrical wiring and connections, or else wirelessly. In some cases, the term bandwidth can include a maximum rate of transfer across a given path.

(36) In these or other examples, at least one of data bandwidth or power bandwidth through the dongles **116**, **118** can be reduced when the thermal output achieves a threshold thermal output (e.g., a predetermined temperature reading). For instance, a micro controller (discussed below) can throttle bandwidth through at least one of the dongles **116**, **118** in response to a temperature sensor in the removable straps **110**, **112** indicating a temperature in excess of a certain temperature, such as one hundred degrees Fahrenheit.

(37) Any of the features, components, parts, including the arrangements and configurations thereof shown in FIG. 1 can be included, either alone or in any combination, in any of the other examples of devices, features, components, and parts shown in the other figures. Likewise, any of the features, components, parts, including the arrangements and configurations thereof shown in the other figures can be included, either alone or in any combination, in the example of the devices, features, components, and parts shown in FIG. 1.

(38) FIG. 2 shows a perspective view of an example of a wearable electronic device **200** that includes a display portion **202** in the form of an HMD with a housing **204**. The display portion **202** can be secured to the head of a user via a modular securement assembly **208** that can include a first removable strap **210**, a second removable strap **212**, and a retention band **214**. The first removable strap **210** can be removably connected to the display portion **202**, or the housing **204** thereof, at a first end **216** of the first removable strap **210**. A second end **218** of the first removable strap **210** can be removably connected to a first end **220** of the retention band **214**. Likewise, the second removable strap **212** can be removably connected to the display portion **202**, or the housing **204** thereof, at a first end **222** of the second removable strap **212**. A second end **224** of the second removable strap **212** can be removably connected to a second end **226** of the retention band **214**.

(39) FIG. 3 shows an exploded perspective view of an example of a wearable electronic device **300**, similar to the device **200** shown in FIG. 2. The device **300** of FIG. 3 includes a display portion

302 in the form of an HMD with a housing **304**. The display portion **302** can be secured to the head of a user via a modular securement assembly **308** that can include a first removable strap **310**, a second removable strap **312**, and a retention band **314**. The first removable strap **310** can be removably connected to the display portion **302**, or the housing **304** thereof, at a first end **316** of the first removable strap **310**. A second end **318** of the first removable strap **310** can be removably connected to a first end **320** of the retention band **314**. Likewise, the second removable strap **312** can be removably connected to the display portion **302**, or the housing **304** thereof, at a first end **322** of the second removable strap **312**. A second end **324** of the second removable strap **312** can be removably connected to a second end **326** of the retention band **314**.

(40) The example of the device **300** in FIG. **3** is shown in an exploded view to illustrate the modularity of the securement assembly **308**, where each of the first and second removable straps **310**, **312** can be individually removed or replaced and removably connected with the retention band **314** and display portion **302** or other display component or other output component such as a speaker component or module.

(41) Any of the features, components, parts, including the arrangements and configurations thereof shown in FIGS. **2** and **3** can be included, either alone or in any combination, in any of the other examples of devices, features, components, and parts shown in the other figures. Likewise, any of the features, components, parts, including the arrangements and configurations thereof shown in the other figures can be included, either alone or in any combination, in the example of the devices, features, components, and parts shown in FIGS. **2** and **3**. For example, at least one of the dongles **116**, **118** shown in FIG. **1** above can be correspondingly implemented with the removable straps **210**, **212** and/or the removable straps **310**, **312** of FIGS. **2-3**.

(42) FIG. **4** illustrates a side profile view of an example removable strap of an HMD system in accordance with one or more examples of the present disclosure. In particular, FIG. **4** illustrates a removable strap **412** that includes an electronics pod **400**, a thermal spreader **402**, and a thermal spreader **404**. Although a single removable strap is shown, it will be appreciated that both removable straps of an HMD system of the present disclosure can include the same or similar structure shown and described in relation to FIG. **4**.

(43) As used herein, the term “electronics pod” refers to a subassembly, an enclosure, or a shell dedicated for housing certain electronics. In certain implementations, electrical components of the electronics pod **400** are communicatively coupled to the HMD **102** (e.g., via wire(s) **534** shown in FIG. **5**). Additionally or alternatively, the electronics pod **400** can be coupled to one or more dongles (e.g., the dongles **116**, **118** discussed above).

(44) Furthermore, the electronics pod **400** can generate thermal energy or heat as a result of operation. In some examples, it is desirable to dissipate this thermal energy or heat away from a user (e.g., towards an ambient environment and away from a user's head). In some examples, it is also desirable to spread this thermal energy or heat away from the electronics pod **400** (e.g., by utilizing the thermal spreaders **402**, **404**). In particular examples, the thermal spreader **404** dissipates thermal energy from inside the electronics pod **400**. Optionally, the thermal spreader **402** also dissipates thermal energy from inside electronics pod **400**.

(45) As will be shown below, a thermal spreaders **402**, **404** are in thermal communication with the electronics pod **400**. For example, the thermal spreaders **402**, **404** contact conductive portions of the electronics pod **400**. In particular examples, the thermal spreaders **402**, **404** are positioned beyond the electronics pod **400**. In these or other examples, the term “beyond” refers to an exterior or outside positioning relative to a boundary/perimeter. For instance, the thermal spreaders **404**, **404** are at least partially positioned beyond the electronics pod **400** (e.g., outside of the exterior shell of the electronics pod **400**).

(46) As used herein, the term “thermal spreader” refers to a material that transfers or distributes heat from a hotter source to a colder source. In some examples, a thermal spreader is a thermally conductive element that disperses or spreads out thermal energy from the electronics pod **400**. To

illustrate, a thermal spreader can include conductive wires, foil, strips, sheets, layers, contacts, etc. Thermal spreaders can also include a variety of materials. For example, thermal spreaders can include copper, graphite, diamond, Silver, Gold, silken carbide, aluminum, tungsten, zinc, carbon fiber (e.g., pitched carbon fiber), etc. In the example of pitched carbon fiber, it will be appreciated that the fibers can be oriented in one or more predetermined directions for directional heat transfer. (47) Any of the features, components, parts, including the arrangements and configurations thereof shown in FIG. 4 can be included, either alone or in any combination, in any of the other examples of devices, features, components, and parts shown in the other figures. Likewise, any of the features, components, parts, including the arrangements and configurations thereof shown in the other figures can be included, either alone or in any combination, in the example of the devices, features, components, and parts shown in FIG. 4.

(48) FIG. 5 illustrates a top cross-sectional profile view of an example electronics pod in accordance with one or more examples of the present disclosure. As shown, the electronics pod **400** includes a thermal shell **500** and a cover **502**. Together, the thermal shell **500** and the cover **502** define an internal volume **504**. Multiple electrical components can be housed within the internal volume **504**. These electrical components can also generate thermal energy during operation.

(49) In addition, the thermal shell **500** and the cover **502** can form an at least partially enclosed bowl or U-shaped cross-section. In particular, the example thermal shell **500** includes a plateaued surface. In some examples the plateaued surface can be oriented towards a user's head. In this manner, audio can be transmitted from the electronics pod **400** in a directional fashion towards a user's ear. In alternative examples, the plateaued surface of the electronics pod **400** can contact a user skin (e.g., for vibrational sound via bone conduction).

(50) In certain examples, the cover **502** includes one or more of a variety of materials. In some examples, the cover **502** includes at least one of a foam portion or an aluminum portion. In particular examples, the cover **502** includes a stainless steel portion. Further in some examples, the cover **502** forms a complete enclosure over the internal volume **504**. In other examples, the cover **502** forms a partial enclosure over the internal volume **504**.

(51) In these or other examples, a bottom surface of the cover **502** can attach to a removable strap. Additionally or alternatively, the cover **502** can be integrated into a removable strap itself. Further, in some examples, the thermal shell **500** includes a variety of layers of material. In some examples, the thermal shell **500** includes a clad (e.g., an overmolded clad). The clad can include a first metal layer **508**, a thermal interface material **510**, and a second metal layer **512**.

(52) The metal layers **508**, **512** can include one or more of a variety of metal materials. In some examples, the metal layers **508**, **512** include stainless steel. In other examples, the metal layers **508**, **512** include chrome, titanium, etc. It will be appreciated, however, that the metal layers **508**, **512** need not be metal. For instance, the layers **508**, **512** can be a variety of insulative materials, such as foam, plastic, rubber, ceramic, etc. It will also be appreciated that the layers **508**, **512** can be different materials, as may be desired.

(53) In some examples, the thermal interface material **510** can include a variety of thermally conductive materials. As used herein, the term “thermal interface material” refers to a material inserted between components or surfaces to enhance a thermal coupling therebetween and/or provide a thermal pathway. Examples of a thermal interface material include a thermal epoxy, thermal paste, thermal adhesive, thermal gap filler, thermally conductive pad, thermal tape, phase-change materials, or thermally conductive coatings (e.g., metallic coatings, diamond coatings, etc.). A thermal interface material can thus have high thermal conductivity. In specific examples, the thermal interface material **510** includes one or more copper layers. In one or more examples, the thermal interface material **510** can move, mold, or conform to the shape of the electronics pod **400**. Moreover, as will be discussed below, the thermal interface material **510** can transfer or dissipate thermal energy out of the internal volume **504**.

(54) An overmold **506** can be positioned over the thermal shell **500**. The overmold **506** can include

a variety of materials. To illustrate, the overmold **506** can include softer materials, textured materials, fabric materials, etc. In particular examples, the overmold **506** includes an elastomer material. For instance, the overmold **506** includes a fluorocarbon rubber (e.g., Viton® rubber). In these or other examples, the overmold **506** can conform to a shape of the thermal shell **500**. Additionally or alternatively, the overmold **506** can provide rigidity or support to the thermal shell **500**.

(55) As mentioned, the electronics pod **400** can house a variety of electrical components. Shown in FIG. 5, the electrical components can include a printed circuit board (PCB) **514**, a battery **516**, a processor such as a microcontroller **518**, a system-on-chip (SoC) **520**, and a speaker **522**.

(56) The terms “PCB” or “printed circuit board” refer to a logic assembly that includes electronic components. The PCB **514** includes electrical connections and circuitry for mounting various components, including the SoC **520**. The PCB **514** can also relay power to mounted electrical components from a power supply (e.g., a battery, not shown in FIG. 3). In certain examples, the PCB **514** is a main logic board. The PCB **514** can be a rigid board (e.g., composed of glass-epoxy compounds). In some examples, the PCB **514** is a multi-layer PCB (e.g., a laminated sandwich structure of conductive and insulating layers). In some examples, the PCB **514** is flexible (e.g., with flexible circuitry made with polyimide). In certain examples, the PCB **514** includes stiffeners added via lamination or pressure sensitive adhesive.

(57) The battery **516** can include a myriad of different types of batteries or power sources. Indeed, the battery **516** can include one or more electrochemical cells with external connections for powering electrical devices or electrical components. For example, in some implementations, the battery **516** includes a lithium ion battery, alkaline battery, etc. In a specific example, the battery **516** includes a rechargeable battery. In other words, the battery **516** can be dispensable or rechargeable, as may be desired.

(58) The microcontroller **518** can direct operation of one or more other components (e.g., within the electronics pod **400** the display **106**, etc.). As used herein, the term “microcontroller” refers to a device capable of generating an electrical (or digital) signal responsive to sensor data from a sensor. In one or more embodiments, a microcontroller includes any of a variety of processors (e.g., a system-on-chip, integrated circuit, driver, application processor, crossover processor, etc.). In some embodiments, a microcontroller further includes one or more memory devices (e.g., individual nonvolatile memory, processor-embedded nonvolatile memory, random access memory, memory integrated circuits, DRAM chips, stacked memory modules, storage devices, memory partitions, etc.). In particular embodiments, a microcontroller further includes one or more of input/output ports, counters, timers, etc. It will be appreciated that such a microcontroller can be mounted on a printed circuit board (e.g., a rigid circuit board or a flexible printed circuit).

(59) The SoC **520** can include an integrated circuit that integrates a combination of electrical components for operation of the HMD system. The terms “SoC,” and “system-on-chip” refer to an electronic chip that generates thermal energy during operation. One or more of the SoC **520**, the microcontroller **518**, or the battery **516** can be a “heat source,” which term generally refers to component(s) that can generate thermal energy. In some examples, the SoC **520** can include a microchip to generate (e.g., drive) visualizations presented at the display **106** (shown in FIG. 1). It will be appreciated that the thermal energy or heat generated by the SoC **520** can become greater over a duration of use. Similarly, the thermal energy or heat generated by the SoC **520** can become greater when executing more data-intensive operations (e.g., for more complex or high fidelity visualizations).

(60) The speaker **522** can include one or more audio-generating components. Example components of the speaker **522** include a transducer, magnet, coil, diaphragm/driver, etc.

(61) Myriad other components in the electronics pod **400** can be included (albeit not expressly shown in FIG. 5). For example, the electronics pod **400** can include a heat sink, microphone, antenna, one or more sensors (e.g., temperature sensors, pressure sensor, accelerometer,

magnetometer, etc.), or other suitable electronic elements.

(62) In one or more examples, components of the electronics pod **400** can be electrically coupled to a power supply positioned outside of the electronics pod **400**. For example, wire(s) **534** can extend through a wire opening **536** defined by the cover **502**. The wire(s) **534** can connect to the PCB **514** on one end, and the wire(s) **534** can connect to a power supply (not shown) on the other end. In this manner, the wire(s) **534** can provide power to each component electrically coupled to the PCB **514**.

(63) Components of the electronics pod **400** can also be thermally coupled to at least one of the ambient environment outside the electronics pod **400** or various thermal elements. To illustrate, the electronics pod **400** comprises a thermal conduit. As used herein, the term “thermal conduit” refers to a thermal path for heat flow. A thermal conduit may be conceptualized as linear or direct (e.g., along wire paths). However, a thermal conduit is not limited to such a flow path. Indeed, thermal paths can be linear or curved (e.g., non-linear), as a function of thermal properties for a given medium (whether solid, liquid, or gaseous). Further, thermal conduits are not limited to two-dimensional space. It will be appreciated that thermal conduits of the present disclosure include three-dimensional thermal paths through a given volume. In at least some examples, however, a thermal conduit of the present disclosure includes at least one of a thermal connector **524** or a thermal connector **526**, both of which can be composed of one or more wires (e.g., copper wires) for conductive heat transfer.

(64) In some examples, the thermal conduit includes a thermal connector **524**. The thermal connector **524** is positioned inside the internal volume **504** and connects the PCB **514** and each associated component to the thermal interface material **510** at a connection point **528**. Alternatively, the thermal connector **524** connects a specific component of the electronics pod **400** (e.g., the SoC **520**) to the thermal interface material **510**.

(65) Thermal energy can be conductively transferred from components of the electronics pod **400** through the thermal connector **524**. In turn, the thermal energy can be spread or dissipated along the thermal interface material **510**. In at least some examples, a thermal conduit includes a thermal connector **526**. The thermal connector **526** is attached to the thermal interface material **510** at the connection point **528**. The thermal connector **526** then extends between clad layers of the thermal shell **500** (or over the thermal shell **500** underneath the overmold **506** as shown). The thermal connector **526** further extends to a connection **538** beyond the electronics pod **400**, where the thermal connector **526** and the thermal interface material **510** thermally couple to the thermal spreader **404**. By coupling the thermal connector **526** and the thermal interface material **510** to the thermal spreader **404**, thermal energy from the electronics pod **400** can be even further dissipated or spread along the removable strap. In specific examples, the thermal spreader **404** directs this thermal energy towards a second end **424** that opposes a first end **422** of the removable strap **412**. In doing so, the thermal energy is directed away from a user's temple.

(66) However, as indicated via dashed lines, the removable strap **412** can include the thermal spreader **402** and associated heat-dissipation elements. The thermal spreader **402**, like the thermal spreader **404**, can connect to the thermal interface material **510** and a thermal connector, in a similar manner as just discussed above. In this way, thermal energy from the electronics pod **400** can be directed along the thermal spreader **402** towards the first end **422** of the removable strap **412**, as may be desired (e.g., to decrease a thermal load through the thermal connector **524**, the thermal connector **526**, and/or the thermal spreader **404**).

(67) To accommodate these and/or other thermal couplings of the present disclosure, the thermal shell **500** includes certain etched portions that expose segments of the thermal interface material **510**. Indeed, the thermal shell **500** includes an etched opening **530** and an etched opening **532**. The etched openings **530**, **532** can be formed in a variety of ways. In some examples, chemical etching may be used to form the etched openings **530**, **532**. In other examples, laser etching may be used to form the etched openings **530**, **532**. In such examples, the etched opening **530** is defined by a removed portion of the metal layer **512**. Similarly, the etched opening **532** is defined by a removed

portion of the metal layer **508**. Through the etched openings **530**, **532**, the thermal interface material **510** is exposed for one or more conductive connections (e.g., for conductive heat transfer). (68) Additionally or alternatively to the thermal connector **524**, heat can be transferred from electrical components of the electronics pod **400** to the thermal interface material **510** via forced convection or non-force convection. For example, thermal energy can convectively move through the etched opening **530** and impinge upon the thermal interface material **510**. As used herein, the terms “conduction” or “natural conduction” refer to the heat transfer via conductively connected components. By contrast, the term “non-force convection” refers to free or natural convection, where air motion is caused by natural, buoyancy forces that result from the density variations due to variations of thermal temperature in the air. Non-forced convection differs from forced convection, where a fluid (e.g., air) is forced to flow by an internal source such as fans, by stirring, or pumps to create an artificially induced convection current.

(69) Any of the features, components, parts, including the arrangements and configurations thereof shown in FIG. 5 can be included, either alone or in any combination, in any of the other examples of devices, features, components, and parts shown in the other figures. Likewise, any of the features, components, parts, including the arrangements and configurations thereof shown in the other figures can be included, either alone or in any combination, in the example of the devices, features, components, and parts shown in FIG. 5.

(70) FIG. 6 shows a top view of a wearable electronic device **600** being worn on the head **101** of a user. The wearable electronic device **600** is the same as or similar to the wearable electronic device **100** discussed above in relation to FIG. 1. Differently however, the wearable electronic device **600** includes a dongle **618**. As shown, the dongle **618** is a split dongle. In particular, the dongle **618** includes a first portion **619** connecting the removable strap **112** and the external DoD **122**. In addition, the dongle **618** includes a second portion **621** connecting the removable strap **112** to at least one of the power supply **120** or the removable strap **110**.

(71) Advantageously, the dongle **618** can provide a variety of use-case applications. For instance, the power supply **120** can additionally provide power to the removable strap **112** via the second portion **621**. In another example, the external DoD **122** can provide data to both of the removable straps **110**, **112** via the dongle **618**. In at least some examples, the dongle **618** can improve bandwidth through the wearable electronic device **600** (e.g., by circumventing the HMD **102** for transmission of data around the wearable electronic device **600**). By transmitting data to the removable strap **110** through the dongle **618**, and in particular through the second portion **621**, the wearable electronic device **600** can also include reduced thermal loads in the bypassed components (e.g., through the removable strap **112** and the HMD **102**).

(72) Any of the features, components, parts, including the arrangements and configurations thereof shown in FIG. 6 can be included, either alone or in any combination, in any of the other examples of devices, features, components, and parts shown in the other figures. Likewise, any of the features, components, parts, including the arrangements and configurations thereof shown in the other figures can be included, either alone or in any combination, in the example of the devices, features, components, and parts shown in FIG. 6.

(73) FIGS. 7-8 illustrate schematic views of example cable management mechanisms for HMD systems in accordance with one or more examples of the present disclosure. In particular, FIG. 7 shows a dongle **718** connected to the removable strap **112**. The dongle **718** can be the same as or similar to the dongles **118**, **618** discussed above. The dongle **718** also includes slack **702** (e.g., a cable portion for routing to the external DoD **122**). To help prevent unwanted positioning or tangling, the retention band **114** can include a cable management mechanism **700**.

(74) The cable management mechanism **700** can route, position, tension, or otherwise manage the slack **702** for the dongle **718**. In some examples, the cable management mechanism **700** includes an external ring, clip, button snap, Velcro® strip, tie, etc. attached to the retention band **114**. In other examples, the cable management mechanism **700** includes an aperture, slot, or recess within the

retention band **114**.

(75) Similarly, FIG. **8** shows a dongle **818** connected to the removable strap **112**. The dongle **818** can be the same as or similar to the dongles **118**, **618** discussed above. Like the dongle **718**, the dongle **818** includes slack **802** (e.g., for routing to the external DoD **122**). A cable management mechanism **800** is configured to efficiently handle the slack **802**, including one or more of a length or tension of the slack **802**.

(76) In some examples, the cable management mechanism **800** includes a retractable spool. Via the retractable spool, the slack **802** can be pulled out or lengthened with manual interaction. In some examples, the slack **802** can be pulled out to a desired length and locked in place such that the retractable spool maintains an amount or tension of the slack **802**. In certain examples, the cable management mechanism **800** can automatically wind the slack **802**. In other examples, the cable management mechanism **800** winds the slack **802** in response to user interaction with at least one of the slack **802** or the cable management mechanism **800**. For instance, the cable management mechanism **800** includes a button release to initiate winding of the slack **802**. In other instances, the cable management mechanism **800** can wind the slack **802** in response to a pull (e.g., a directional tug) of the slack **802**.

(77) Any of the features, components, parts, including the arrangements and configurations thereof shown in FIGS. **7-8** can be included, either alone or in any combination, in any of the other examples of devices, features, components, and parts shown in the other figures. Likewise, any of the features, components, parts, including the arrangements and configurations thereof shown in the other figures can be included, either alone or in any combination, in the example of the devices, features, components, and parts shown in FIGS. **7-8**.

(78) As mentioned above, the electronics pod (e.g., the electronics pod **400** discussed above) can be utilized for data transfer and audio generation. In some examples, however, data transfer can occur at locations outside of the electronics pod. The following figures relate to such examples.

(79) In these or other examples, locating elements for data transfer (e.g., active Universal Serial Bus “USB” components) outside of the electronics pod can provide certain advantages. For instance, in some examples, a thermal environment of the electronics pod can be improved and/or more easily controlled by housing speaker components in the electronics pod and relocating or otherwise modifying the operation of the data transfer components so that the entire thermal load of the speaker components and the data transfer components are not both borne by the electronics pod. To illustrate, and as mentioned above, the device **100** can monitor the thermal environment of the electronics pod (e.g., the electronics pod **400**) via one or more temperature sensors and correspondingly throttle the power consumption of at least one of audio components or data transfer components. In this way, the device **100** can maintain predetermined thermal levels of the electronics pod. However, by removing data transfer components from the electronics pod, the device **100** can significantly reduce the power consumption (and therefore the thermal energy generation) within the electronics pod. In certain implementations, removing data transfer components from the electronics pod can reduce power consumption within the electronics pod, and in some examples, the reduction in power can range from about 30 percent to about 85 percent.

(80) According to other examples, separating data transfer from speaker components in the electronics pod can, in some instances, reduce electric noise (e.g., electromagnetic frequency radiation) generated within the electronics pod, thereby improving audio clarity and/or component integrity. Additionally, separating data transfer from the speaker components in the electronics pod can in some examples, result in a reduction in data transfer latency. As will be described below, the data transfer components can be moved closer to another device (e.g., the external DoD **122**)—where “closer” in location refers to a relative distance or path of travel for data bytes along a wired connection. That is, the data transfer components can be moved out of the electronics pod for a relatively closer positioning along the wired connection to the external DoD **122**.

(81) Low-latency connections via wired connections (as opposed to wireless connections) can

allow a variety of use cases with various external DoDs **122**. For instance, a low-latency connection of the present disclosure can allow robust, fast data connections to other devices, such as audio/peripheral devices (e.g., for spatial audio or surround sound capabilities without lag to visual outputs). In another example, a low-latency connection can allow the device **100** to connect to multiple, large high-resolution displays (e.g., 8K resolution displays for use, in-store demonstrations, or developer testing) without connectivity issues. In yet another example, a low-latency connection can allow the device **100** to connect to other head-mountable devices in real-time (e.g., for multiplayer or shared-audience experiences, and the like).

(82) In particular examples, and as will now be discussed in relation to FIGS. **9-10**, data transfer components can be moved to the dongle. FIG. **9** illustrates a side view of a dongle **900** in accordance with one or more examples of the present disclosure. As shown, the dongle **900** can include a connection **904** that connects the dongle **900** to a removable strap **902**, which can be the same as, or similar to, the removable strap **112** discussed above in relation to the foregoing figures. Via the connection **904**, the dongle **900** can transfer power and/or data between the removable strap **902** and another device (e.g., the external DoD **122**). In some examples, the connection **904** is removably attached to the removable strap **112**. In other examples, the connection **904** is permanently attached to the removable strap **112**. As will be discussed below in relation to FIGS. **11-12**, the connection **904** can include a flex circuit that is formed (e.g., bent, folded, rolled, collapsed, etc.) to fit inside a dome, shell, housing, or enclosure at the connection **904**.

(83) The dongle **900** can further include a cable **906** extending between the connection **904** and a boot **908**. The cable **906** can include a variety of different wires, strands, or groupings of wire, etc. that can transfer data and/or power between the boot **908** and the connection **904**. In some examples, one or more wires of the cable **906** are shielded. Further, in some examples, the cable **906** is rotatable relative to the connection **904** (e.g., to provide different angular orientations as may be desired for increased user comfort or different use-case scenarios). In other examples, the cable **906** is fixed relative to the connection **904**.

(84) The boot **908** can include a portion of the dongle **900** that connects the dongle **900** to another device (e.g., the external DoD **122**). In some examples, the boot **908** can include a variety of different ports, connectors, adapters, plugs, prongs, mating features, etc. Additionally, the boot **908** can include one or more computing elements, such as a processor (e.g., a system-on-chip, integrated circuit, driver, application processor, crossover processor, etc.). In some examples, the boot **908** further includes one or more memory devices (e.g., individual nonvolatile memory, processor-embedded nonvolatile memory, random access memory, memory integrated circuits, DRAM chips, stacked memory modules, storage devices, memory partitions, etc.). In a particular exemplary implementation, the boot **908** includes a particular type of connection, such as a USB-C connection.

(85) By including one or more computing elements in the boot **908**, the boot **908** can offload processes performed elsewhere by the device **100**. For example, the boot **908** can serve as the data transfer hub where data transfer between the device **100** and another device (e.g., the external DoD **122**) can occur. By offloading one or more processes (e.g., data transfer) from other areas of the device **100**, the boot **908** can provide improved thermal levels in the electronics pod **400**, reduced e-noise with the speaker components in the electronics pod **400**, and/or decreased data transfer latency. Additional details regarding the boot **908** are discussed below in relation to FIG. **10**.

(86) FIG. **10** illustrate a close-up view of the boot **908** in accordance with one or more examples of the present disclosure. As shown, the boot **908** can include a main logic board (“MLB”) **1000**. The MLB **1000** can include a printed circuit board, including a single-layer substrate, a multi-layer substrate, a rigid substrate, a flexible substrate, a rigid-flex substrate, a high frequency circuit board, an aluminum-backed circuit board, and the like.

(87) The boot **908** can additionally include a thermal spreader **1002**. The thermal spreader **1002** can wrap at least partially around the boot **908**. In some examples, the spreader **1002** is positioned

adjacent to an exterior surface of the boot **908** (e.g., for increased heat transfer to the external environment). In these or other examples, the thermal spreader **1002** can be the same as, or similar to, the thermal spreaders **402**, **404** discussed above. Accordingly, the thermal spreader **1002** can include conductive wires, foil, strips, sheets, layers, contacts, etc. The thermal spreader **1002** can also include a variety of materials. For example, the thermal spreader **1002** can include copper, graphite, diamond, silver, gold, silken carbide, aluminum, tungsten, zinc, carbon fiber (e.g., pitched carbon fiber), etc. In the example of pitched carbon fiber, it will be appreciated that the fibers can be oriented in one or more predetermined directions for directional heat transfer. In certain examples, the thermal spreader **1002** is also a metal shield cage (e.g., for electrical noise isolation).

(88) The boot **908** can further include thermal connectors **1004**, **1006**. The thermal connectors **1004**, **1006** can reduce thermal levels inside the boot **908** (particularly at the MLB **1000**) by thermally connecting the MLB **1000** to the thermal spreader **1002**. In this way, heat can transfer out of the boot **908** (i.e., away from the MLB **1000**) and into the external environment around the boot **908**. In these or other examples, the thermal connectors **1004**, **1006** can include a conductive joint (e.g., a weld, soldered joint, etc.), thermally conductive material, thermally conductive filler, and/or thermal tape or adhesive.

(89) Any of the features, components, parts, including the arrangements and configurations thereof shown in FIGS. **9-10** can be included, either alone or in any combination, in any of the other examples of devices, features, components, and parts shown in the other figures. Likewise, any of the features, components, parts, including the arrangements and configurations thereof shown in the other figures can be included, either alone or in any combination, in the example of the devices, features, components, and parts shown in FIGS. **9-10**.

(90) As mentioned above, the connection **904** between the removable strap **902** and the cable **906** can include various electrical connections. The following discussion includes further detail regarding a flex circuit and associated wire terminations compatible with a small form factor of the connection **904**.

(91) FIGS. **11-12** illustrate an exploded assembly view and a cross-sectional view, respectively, of the connection **904** in accordance with one or more examples of the present disclosure. As shown, the connection **904** can include a flex circuit **1100**. The flex circuit **1100** can include a variety of flexible circuit boards that have one or more portions that can be bent, folded, rolled, malleably fitted, or otherwise manipulated to a desired configuration.

(92) In some examples, the flex circuit **1100** can include termination areas **1102**. The termination areas **1102** can correspond to hot bar regions (e.g., active, hot, or electrically conductive areas) where wires from the cable **906** can terminate onto the flex circuit **1100**. In some examples, the termination areas **1102** can include soldered portions that electrically connect wires to the termination areas **1102**. Additionally or alternatively, the termination areas **1102** can include stiffeners (e.g., to ensure the termination areas **1102** are not bent or deformed, causing undesired stress/strain at the wire terminations).

(93) In particular examples, the termination areas **1102** include a set of termination areas **1102a-1102d**. In certain examples, the termination areas **1102a-1102d** are interspaced by flexible areas **1104** (namely, flexible areas **1104a-1104d**). The flexible areas **1104a-1104d** can include flexible portions of the flex circuit **1100**, including portions that are malleable, bendable, foldable, or otherwise manipulate-able. By including the flexible areas **1104a-1104d** between the termination areas **1102a-1102d**, the flexible circuit **1100** can be formed into a desired shape that fits within the connection **904**. This assembly approach can facilitate a small form factor for the connection **904** despite a relatively large number of wires within the cable **906**. Indeed, without the flexible areas **1104a-1104d**, the connecting circuit board could potentially take up a comparatively greater amount of real estate, and the amount (i.e., length) of wire to form the connections could significantly increase. In contrast, reduced form-factor configurations (e.g., folded configurations as shown in FIG. **12**) of the flex circuit **1100**—enabled by the flexible areas **1104a-1104d**—allow

wires to terminate at the termination areas **1102a-1102d** in a densely clustered manner. For instance, the termination areas **1102a-1102d** can be folded on top of each other in sequential fashion as the wire-termination process is performed, thereby reducing wire consumption and unnecessary wire slack).

(94) The below description discusses one example configuration of the flex circuit **1100** when positioned within the connection **904**. As shown in FIG. **12**, the flex circuit **1100** can be positioned within the connection **904** in a reduced form-factor configuration. In particular, the flex circuit **1100** is folded. However, other reduced form-factor implementations of the flex circuit **1100** can include rolled configurations, shaped configurations, and the like.

(95) Further shown in FIG. **12**, wire groups **1200a**, **1200b** are respectively joined to the flex circuit **1100** at termination areas **1202a**, **1202b**. The termination areas **1202a**, **1202b** are spaced apart by a flexible area **1204**. In particular, the termination areas **1202a**, **1202b** can be folded onto each other, thus positioning the wire groups **1200a**, **1200b** in a stacked configuration.

(96) In these or other examples, the flex circuit **1100** can include a spacer **1206**. The spacer **1206** can include a material that is resistant to deformation or otherwise prevents compression of the flex circuit **1100** into itself. Thus, the spacer **1206** can include a variety of pads, guards, or bumpers that can protect the flex circuit from damaging itself. In addition, the spacer **1206** can include a mechanical stop that prevents the flex circuit **1100** from over rotating or over bending (which could create undesired sharp bending angles at the flexible area **1204** and lend to a potential failure point).

(97) Any of the features, components, parts, including the arrangements and configurations thereof shown in FIGS. **11-12** can be included, either alone or in any combination, in any of the other examples of devices, features, components, and parts shown in the other figures. Likewise, any of the features, components, parts, including the arrangements and configurations thereof shown in the other figures can be included, either alone or in any combination, in the example of the devices, features, components, and parts shown in FIGS. **11-12**.

(98) While the exemplary systems and methods can operate without access to personal information data, in some examples, the present systems and methods can leverage personal information data to enhance or customize the experience for a user. When such personal information data is used by the present exemplary systems and methods, such use of personal information data shall be in compliance with well-established privacy policies and/or privacy practices, and shall meet or exceed industry or governmental requirements for maintaining personal information data private and secure. Further personal information data should be managed and handled in a way to minimize risks of unintentional or unauthorized access or use.

(99) The foregoing description includes specific nomenclature to provide a thorough understanding of the described embodiments. However, the specific details are not required in order to practice the described embodiments and are presented for purposes of illustration and description. They are not intended to be exhaustive or to limit the embodiments to the precise forms disclosed. Rather, many modifications and variations are possible in view of the above teachings.

Claims

1. A head-mountable display (HMD) system, comprising: a display portion including a display; and a modular securement assembly connectable to the display portion, the modular securement assembly comprising: a removable strap comprising an electronics pod with a thermal shell and a thermal conduit, the thermal shell comprising a clad including: a first metal layer; a second metal layer; and a third metal layer disposed between the first metal layer and the second metal layer, wherein the third metal layer comprises a copper layer; and a retention band connectable to the removable strap.

2. The HMD system of claim 1, further comprising a processor that, in response to a threshold

thermal output of the electronics pod, throttles a power bandwidth or a data bandwidth through the removable strap.

3. The HMD system of claim 1, further comprising a dongle connectable to the removable strap and to at least one of a power supply, a computing device, or an external display.

4. The HMD system of claim 3, wherein the dongle comprises a split dongle configured to connect the removable strap to the power supply and at least one of the computing device or the external display.

5. The HMD system of claim 3, wherein the dongle comprises a split dongle configured to connect the removable strap to an additional removable strap.

6. The HMD system of claim 1, wherein the first metal layer comprises a first stainless steel layer and the second metal layer comprises a second stainless steel layer.

7. The HMD system of claim 1, wherein the thermal conduit comprises a first thermal connector configured to thermally couple one or more components of the electronics pod and the copper layer.

8. The HMD system of claim 7, wherein the thermal conduit comprises a second thermal connector configured to thermally couple the copper layer and a thermal spreader positioned beyond the electronics pod.

9. A removable strap for a head-mountable display system, the removable strap comprising: a display connector; a dongle connector; an electronics pod positioned between the display connector and the dongle connector, the electronics pod comprising a clad thermal shell including a first layer, a second layer, and an internal layer disposed between the first layer and the second layer, the internal layer comprising a thermal interface material different than the first layer and the second layer, the electronics pod comprising a heat source; and a thermal spreader positioned at least between the electronics pod and the dongle connector, the thermal spreader configured to dissipate thermal energy from the electronics pod.

10. The removable strap of claim 9, wherein the thermal shell is overmolded with a fluorocarbon rubber.

11. The removable strap of claim 9, wherein the electronics pod comprises an outer surface defining an etched portion exposing the thermal shell.

12. The removable strap of claim 11, wherein the thermal spreader is in contact with the thermal shell through the etched portion.

13. The removable strap of claim 9, wherein the thermal shell is at least partially exposed inside the electronics pod.

14. The removable strap of claim 9, wherein the thermal interface material comprises at least one of a copper layer or a graphite layer.

15. The removable strap of claim 9, wherein the heat source comprises at least one of a battery or a system-on-chip.

16. A head-mountable display (HMD) system, comprising: a display portion including a display; a modular securement assembly connectable to the display portion, the modular securement assembly comprising: a first removable strap comprising a first thermal shell and a first thermal spreader, the first thermal shell comprising a first layer, a second layer, and an internal layer disposed between the first layer and the second layer, the internal layer comprising a thermal interface material different than the first layer and the second layer; a second removable strap comprising a second thermal shell and a second thermal spreader; and a retention band connected to the first removable strap and the second removable strap; a first dongle comprising a first bandwidth and configured to connect the first removable strap to a power supply; and a second dongle comprising a second bandwidth greater than the first bandwidth, the second dongle configured to connect the second removable strap to at least one of a computing device or an external display.

17. The HMD system of claim 16, wherein at least data is transmissive through the second dongle.

